# Nebius (NBIS) vs. AI-cloud peers: where the unit economics are better or worse, and why

To: NBIS research team | From: Aadit Prayag | Thu Oct 8, 2026 (refresh of the Oct 4 draft) | Data: Q2'26 (Jun-26) unless noted; peers at latest available period | Source: peers/comparison.xlsx (model v0.9e locks; Sites rebuilt Oct 8 ~11:15 PM ET to match the four peer site appendices)

## BOTTOM LINE

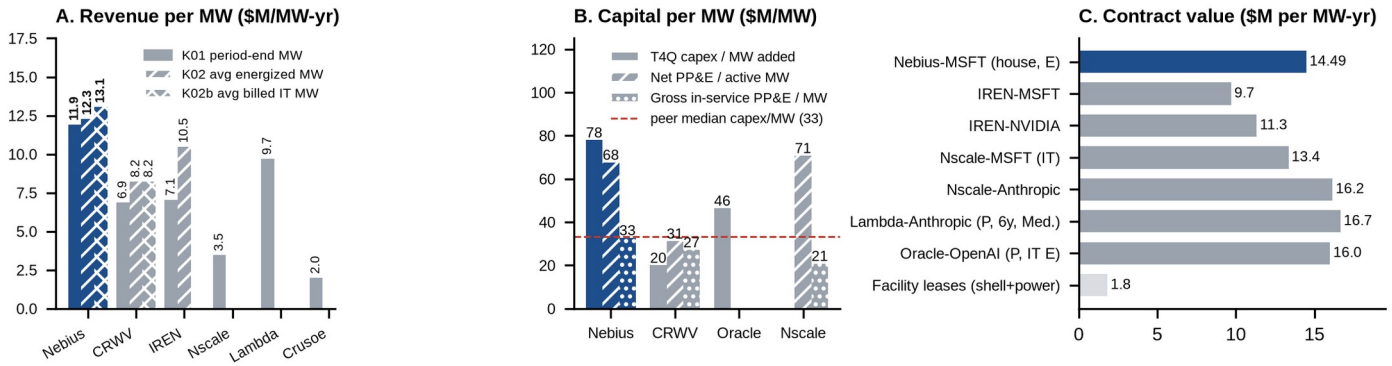
**Clearest beat: revenue density.** Nebius earns $13.06M per average billed IT MW (K02b, E) vs. $8.24M at CoreWeave, and $12.28M per average active MW (K02) vs. a $9.36M peer median (CoreWeave 8.24, IREN 10.48). It also leads on adj. EBITDA per MW ($6.10M vs. $4.83M at CoreWeave), realized $/GPU-hr ($3.03 vs. $1.66 median, E) and top-customer share (24% vs. 36% CoreWeave, 52% Nscale).
**Clearest trail: capital intensity.** Trailing-4Q cash capex per MW added is $77.9M (E) vs. $20.0M at CoreWeave (3.9x) and a $33.2M median, and 25% of contractual interest is capitalized (median 7%), because Nebius is pre-funding owned 2027 capacity. Funding cost and backlog coverage are in line (5.1% blended debt cost vs. 4.8% median; RPO 16.3x run-rate revenue vs. 14.1x). The Nebius MW denominator is a Capacity estimate, so read the density lead as directional.

**Forward bar (billed-IT basis, context only, not scored):** the YE26 run-rate guide implies $27.2M per billed IT MW ($7B / 257.7 MW base) to $31.7M ($9B / 284.2 MW high). Street FY27 ex-Microsoft is $27.6M per billed MW (($12.3B - $2.64B Microsoft) / (531.8 - 182.3 Vineland billed MW-yr), model v0.9e²); that is the figure to hold against peers, whose $/MW mixes carry no $14.5M Microsoft anchor (blended $23.1M is a memo only; high path $18.7M blended / $20.3M ex-Microsoft). Peer contract prices run $9.7-16.7M per MW-yr (top: Lambda-Anthropic ~$16.7M, 6-yr, press, Medium confidence; page 3). Against today's K02b of $13.06M, the bar is roughly 2.12x on FY27 ex-Microsoft and 2.08x on the YE26 base guide (2.43x on the YE26 high path): it needs a much richer exit mix (company cites Q3 short-term deals >$40M/MW), not today's pricing.

## PEER BY PEER: WHERE NEBIUS IS BETTER / WORSE (SAME KPI DEFINITIONS AS THE COMPARISON)

| Peer | Nebius better | Nebius worse | Net |
|---|---|---|---|
| CoreWeave | Rev/billed IT MW 13.06 vs 8.24; adj. EBITDA/MW 6.10 vs 4.83; top customer 24% vs 36%; debt cost 5.1% vs 8.4%; RPO cover 16.3x vs 10.1x; life 5 vs 6 yrs (implied 5.71 vs 6.47). | T4Q capex/MW added 77.9 vs 20.0; net PP&E/MW 67.6 vs 31.2; capitalized interest 25% vs 13%; RPO within 24m 36% vs 41%; contracted/active 18.1x vs 2.5x. | Beat: density. Trail: capex/MW. |
| IREN | Rev/avg MW 12.28 vs 10.48 (IREN Sep-25, E); $/GPU-hr 3.03 vs 1.66; incremental rev/new MW 13.5 vs 6.8; rev/GPU hardware 0.47x vs 0.20x; debt/RPO 0.23 vs 1.51; implied life 5.71 vs 6.97. | Debt cost 5.1% vs 1.9% (convert-heavy blend; IREN's Aug-26 GPU financing is 9.0%, iren_kpis.md); RPO cover 16.3x vs 18.1x; RPO within 24m 36% vs 43.1%. Capex/MW and concentration n/d. | Beat: rev/MW. Trail: debt cost. |
| Oracle OCI | Incremental rev/new MW 13.5 vs 9.3 (E); RPO cover 16.3x vs 8.3x; within 24m 36% vs 29% (E); life 5 vs 6 yrs (implied 5.71 vs 7.44). | T4Q capex/MW 77.9 vs 46.4 (E; Oracle capex 100% to OCI = upper bound); 3 customers >=10% vs 0; debt cost 5.1% vs 4.8%; debt/RPO 0.23 vs 0.20. Rev/MW n/d (no installed MW). | Beat: backlog cover. Trail: capex/MW, concentration. |
| Nscale | Rev/period-end MW 11.92 vs 3.47; adj. EBITDA/MW 6.10 vs -4.92; $/GPU-hr 3.03 vs 1.29 (E); top customer 24% vs 52%; within 24m 36% vs 16%; implied life 5.71 vs 6.38. | Gross in-service PP&E/MW 32.7 vs 20.8; net PP&E/MW 67.6 vs 70.7; capitalized interest 25% vs 0%; RPO cover 16.3x vs 201x (Nscale pre-ramp). Debt cost: Nscale 18.7% is legacy debt (excluded); marginal ~6.25% (E). | Beat: EBITDA/MW. Trail: PP&E/MW. |
| Lambda | Rev/period-end MW 11.92 vs 9.70 (Lambda Q2'25, press inputs); $/GPU-hr 3.03 vs 2.09 (E); rev/GPU 26.5 vs 18.2 $K/GPU-yr. | Price realization 54% vs 70% of list (E); top >=10% customers combined 59% vs 50% (Lambda Amazon+Microsoft, P). Capex, life, debt cost, RPO n/d (Lambda DDTL 6.78% R is facility-level; Nebius K29 n/d). | Beat: rev/MW. Trail: realization (directional). |
| Crusoe | Rev/period-end MW 11.92 vs 2.00 (E; Crusoe FY26E revenue on ~1 GW GROSS MW, landlord+cloud mix: not like-for-like). | Contracted/active 18.1x vs 6.0x; evidenced-active hyperscale site: Abilene ~618 MW delivered (421-618; D on R, Oracle Sep 10; IT vs gross basis unstated) vs Vineland 57-75 MW (base 66). Net PP&E/MW 12.5 is shell+power only (excluded). Most KPIs n/d. | Beat: rev/MW (weak comp). Trail: execution. |

$M/MW-yr unless noted; capex and PP&E in $M/MW. Nebius MW = Capacity estimate (E). K02b = revenue per average BILLED IT MW (Nebius 176.1 IT MW; CoreWeave K02b = K02, active ~ billed); other peers publish no billed-MW series (n/d). Flags and medians: comparison.xlsx Ranking; full scorecard on page 3. ²FY27 billed IT MW = team model v0.9e (source of truth; Drivers B34/C34): 531.8 base / 659.2 high, engine-linked (non-Vineland path + Vineland 182.3 billed MW-yr = Microsoft FY27 revenue $2,643.8M / $14.5M). Today's K02b (13.06) is blended, i.e. includes Microsoft revenue.




Source: peers/comparison.xlsx (Comparison, Contracts_$MWyr). C: Nebius-MSFT = house $14.49M per IT MW (E, model Contracts!E12). Nebius MW = Capacity estimate (E); K02b = avg billed IT MW (Nebius 176.1; CRWV K02b = K02). Latest period per peer: Lambda Q2'25 press; Crusoe gross MW, FY26E revenue; IREN K02 Sep-25. C: facility lease = Applied Digital-CoreWeave 1.8 (pack range 1.2-1.9). Comp band 9.7-16.7 (top Lambda-Anthropic, 6-yr, press, Medium).

## WHY NEBIUS IS BETTER

- **Mix and pricing.** Realized $3.03/GPU-hr (E) against a fleet-weighted list of $5.61 is a 54% price-realization index, vs. 18% at CoreWeave (list $9.20) and 70% at Lambda (E, Q2'25). CoreWeave's book is dominated by long-dated reserved hyperscaler pricing; more of Nebius's revenue is near list (our inference; the $/GPU-hr also includes non-GPU-hour revenue). Q2'26 'landmark' deals averaged $20-25M ACV per MW (company, MW basis unstated) vs. a 2026 base of ~$12M/MW.
- **Young, Blackwell-heavy fleet; little dilution yet.** Revenue per $ of GPU hardware is 0.47x vs. 0.34x at CoreWeave and 0.20x at IREN; incremental revenue per new MW is $13.5M vs. a $6.8M median. Timing flatters Nebius: energized 181.5 → 193 MW in Q2'26 (Estimated, Capacity base case), not a growth signal: +11.5 MW is small next to the gap between the 800 MW-1 GW YE26 connected target (company) and our 257.7 MW YE26 billed IT path (E). CoreWeave's new MW bill with a lag.
- **Owned sites show up in EBITDA per MW.** Adj. EBITDA per average MW $6.10M (E) vs. $4.83M at CoreWeave, which leases shells at ~$1.8-1.9M per MW-yr (Applied Digital, Galaxy facility leases) inside operating cost. Nebius's owned capacity moves that cost into capex and depreciation.
- **Conservative depreciation and broader customer base.** 5-year GPU/server life (from 4 in 2026) vs. 6 at CoreWeave and Oracle; implied life 5.71 yrs vs. 6.72 median (CoreWeave 6.47 after the Oct 8 K18 fix). Top customer 24% (then 21%, 14%; 59% combined) vs. CoreWeave 36%/26% (72% combined).

## WHY NEBIUS IS WORSE

- **Capex per MW added $77.9M vs. $33.2M median.** Mostly timing: $7.8B of PP&E was not yet in use at Jun-26 (2027 capacity), and Nebius buys land and builds shells and substations where CoreWeave leases. On CoreWeave's in-service definition (K12) Nebius FY25 is $19.7M/MW vs. $18.7M: in line, so the gap is pre-funding, not overpaying. Gross in-service PP&E per MW is still higher ($32.7M vs. $24.0M median): owned infrastructure plus costlier GPUs per MW.
- **Capitalized interest 25% of contractual interest (median 7%).** $40.2M capitalized vs. $119.1M reported Q2'26 interest, so P&L interest understates the cost of carry by about a third; it returns as depreciation when those assets go live.
- **Execution.** Vineland has ~66 MW (range 57-75) energized of 300 MW contracted (Yellow/Red): 62 rented gensets with a ~107 MW IT ceiling, a $1.07M NJDEP fine with a permit deadline ~early/mid Nov, and stop-construction orders not publicly lifted. Contracted/active is 18.1x vs. 2.5x at CoreWeave; only CoreWeave Denton (~260 MW) and Crusoe Abilene (~618 MW delivered per Oracle Sep 10, D on R; range 421-618; IT vs gross basis unstated) show hundreds of evidenced-active MW.

## IN LINE: FUNDING AND BACKLOG

Blended debt cost 5.1% vs. 4.8% median (CoreWeave 8.4%, Oracle 4.8%, IREN 1.9%); implied cash cost 5.6% vs. 6.1%. Marginal secured debt costs more across the group (CoreWeave ~9-10%, IREN 9.0%, Lambda DDTL 6.78%), so owned-site funding will likely cost more than the blend. RPO is 16.3x run-rate revenue (14.1x median) with 36% due within 24 months (35%); debt/RPO 0.23x vs. 0.27x. The Microsoft anchor works out to about $14.49M per IT MW-yr on our house estimate ($17.4B over five years on ~240 IT MW, model Contracts!E12; neither company states the MW), vs. IREN-Microsoft $9.7M, Nscale-Microsoft $13.4M, Nscale-Anthropic $16.2M and Lambda-Anthropic $16.7M (band top; P, Medium): mid-pack, so today's density lead comes from realized mix, not a richer anchor.

## SHARE-COUNT CONVENTION (DEBT VS. IF-CONVERTED)

Primary convention at today's price: the new Feb-2030 (conv. $313.46) and Feb-2034 (conv. $324.65) notes count as DEBT while NBIS trades below their conversion prices, so FD = 358.56M with the $5.75B face in debt (at the $237.15 10/7 close both series are out of the money). If-converted (price >= $324.65): FD = 376.65M with ALL convert debt removed from EV; between $313.46 and $324.65 only the 2030s convert (369.56M). Spread +5.05% shares (per-share values ~4.8% lower at constant equity value); model v0.9e solves each scenario under the treatment consistent with its own PT. Never mix share and debt sides. 358.34M (v0.9d, 6/30 pre-exchange) is historical only. No KPI in this memo is per-share, so nothing above moves.

## WHAT WOULD CHANGE THE VIEW / WHAT TO WATCH

- **Nebius Q3'26 print (~Nov 10, est.; not announced by the company):** a reported energized or billing MW figure would replace our (E) denominators; at the top of the 157-229 MW identified-site range, period-end revenue/MW drops to ~$10.0M (from $11.92M). Also watch capex vs. in-service additions, capitalized interest and concentration. As the YE26 build lands, revenue/MW will dilute the way CoreWeave's did.
- **Vineland permits:** NJDEP genset permit (~early/mid Nov), lifting of the Aug 6/10 stop-construction orders, Bloom energization.
- **Peers:** Nscale S-1/A (IPO talk ~Oct 15, press, unconfirmed) with active MW; whether CoreWeave's ~70% July price increase lifts revenue/MW off $8.2M; IREN Horizons 2-4; Abilene buildings 7-8 (618 of ~824 MW delivered) and the Texas data-center permit pause (TCEQ report Oct 19); any Oracle installed-MW disclosure (site appendices).

## DATA-QUALITY NOTE

Nebius MW is a Capacity & Power estimate (mixed IT/gross; 193 MW base, identified sites 157-229); Nebius GPUs (~87k) are modeled, so every per-MW and per-GPU Nebius figure is (E). K02b uses Capacity billing IT MW, not energized or gross MW. Lambda and Crusoe are press-based, mixed-vintage points; Oracle has no installed-MW figure and capex is 100% allocated to OCI (upper bound); IREN K02 is Sep-25. Most medians rest on one to four peers. CoreWeave K18 now reads 6.47 yrs (pack bug 16.67 fixed Oct 8). Tags: R reported, P press, D derived, E estimated. Sources: peers/comparison.xlsx; crwv/iren/oracle_kpis.md; private_peers.md; sites/site_verification.md + appendix_*.pdf (Oct 8); capacity/site_verification.md; filings/fd_share_bridge.md; model/nebius_model.xlsx v0.9e (Drivers, Judge_Slide).

# One-page summary: Nebius vs. each peer (comparison.xlsx Comparison / Ranking, Q2'26 unless noted)

Thu Oct 8, 2026 | Flag = Ranking tab (Nebius vs. comparable-peer median; >10% gap = Better/Worse) | value (tag) | n/d = not disclosed / not computable on the same definition

| KPI (unit) | Nebius | CoreWeave | IREN | Oracle OCI | Nscale | Lambda | Crusoe | Peer median | Flag |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Revenue per MW:** Revenue per avg BILLED IT MW (K02b)[1] [$M/MW-yr] | **13.06 (E)** | 8.24 (D) | n/d | n/d | n/d | n/d | n/d | 8.24 | **Better** |
| **Revenue per MW:** Revenue per avg active MW (K02) [$M/MW-yr] | **12.28 (E)** | 8.24 (D) | 10.48 (E) | n/d | n/d | n/d | n/d | 9.36 | **Better** |
| **Capex per MW:** T4Q cash capex / T4Q new active MW (K13) [$M/MW] | **77.9 (E)** | 20.0 (D) | n/d | 46.4 (E) | n/d | n/d | n/d | 33.2 | **Worse** |
| **Capex per MW:** In-service additions / new MW, CRWV def. (K12) [$M/MW] | **19.7 (E)** | 18.7 (D) | n/d | n/d | n/d | n/d | n/d | 18.7 | **In line** |
| **Depreciation life:** Useful life, tech equipment (K16) [years] | **5 (R)** | 6 (R) | 5 (R) | 6 (R) | 5.5 (R) | n/d | n/d | 5.75 | **Better** |
| **Depreciation life:** Implied depreciable life = 1/yield (K18) [years] | **5.71 (D)** | 6.47 (D) | 6.97 (D) | 7.44 (D) | 6.38 (D) | n/d | n/d | 6.72 | **Better** |
| **Cost of funding:** Weighted eff. cost of debt (K28) [%] | **5.1 (D)** | 8.4 (D) | 1.9 (D) | 4.8 (D) | 18.7 (D)† | n/d | n/d | 4.8 | **In line** |
| **Cost of funding:** Implied cash cost of debt (K36) [%] | **5.6 (D)** | 7.8 (D) | 1.7 (D) | 4.4 (D) | 22.2 (D) | n/d | n/d | 6.1 | **In line** |
| **Backlog coverage:** RPO / annualized revenue (K23) [years] | **16.3 (D)** | 10.1 (D) | 18.1 (D) | 8.3 (D) | 200.6 (D) | n/d | n/d | 14.1 | **In line** |
| **Backlog coverage:** RPO % recognized within 24m (K22) [%] | **36 (R)** | 41 (R) | 43.1 (D) | 29 (E) | 16 (R) | n/d | n/d | 35 | **In line** |
| **Customer concentration:** Largest customer % of revenue (K24) [%] | **24 (R)** | 36 (R) | n/d | n/d | 52 (R) | n/d | n/d | 44 | **Better** |

[1]K02b = revenue per average BILLED IT MW (Capacity billing path; Nebius 176.1 IT MW avg Q1-Q2'26), not energized or gross MW; CoreWeave K02b = K02 (active ~ billed); other peers publish no billed-MW series. K02 uses average energized MW (Nebius 181.5/193 MW, Capacity estimate). †Shown but excluded from the median (Nscale K28 = legacy $137M debt; marginal secured ~6.25% E). Periods: IREN K02 Sep-25; Oracle May-26 (FQ4 FY26), K18 Aug-26; Nscale H1'26; Lambda/Crusoe mostly n/d (press-only private peers). Nscale K23 is pre-ramp (tiny H1'26 revenue vs. $56.4B RPO). Lower is better for capex/MW, cost of debt and concentration; shorter life = more conservative (Better). K12 (CoreWeave in-service definition) is Nebius FY25.

## Hyperscaler / AI-lab compute contracts: implied price per MW (comparison.xlsx Contracts_$MWyr; TCV / term / MW)

| Provider | Customer | Signed | TCV ($M) | Tag | Term (yrs) | MW stated / IT MW | $M per MW-yr (stated MW) | $M per IT MW-yr |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Nebius | Microsoft | 2025-09-08 | 17,393 | R | 5.0 | n/d / 240 (E) | n/d | 14.49 (E, house; model Contracts!E12) |
| Nebius | Meta #1 | 2025-11-01 | 2,881 | R | 5.0 | n/d / 50 | n/d | 11.5 (MW E, low conf.) |
| Nebius | Meta #2 (dedicated) | 2026-03-13 | 12,000 | R | 5.0 | n/d / n/d | n/d | n/d |
| Nebius | Meta #2 backstop (contingent) | 2026-03-13 | 15,000 | R (up to; contingent) | 5.0 | n/d / n/d | n/d | n/d |
| Nebius | 4 'landmark' Q2'26 customers (unnamed) | Q2'26 | n/d | n/d | n/d | n/d / n/d | 20-25 (ACV/MW, R) | basis n/d |
| IREN | Microsoft | 2025-11-03 | 9,700 | R | 5.0 | 200 / 200 | 9.7 | 9.7 |
| IREN | NVIDIA | 2026-05 (8-K) | 3,400 | R | 5.0 | 60 / n/d | 11.3 | n/d |
| Nscale | Microsoft (all SOWs) | 2025-09..2026-04 | 43,800 | R (up to) | 5.5 | n/d / 596 | n/d | 13.4 |
| Nscale (Aker JV) | Microsoft - Narvik | 2025-09-17 | 6,200 | R | 5.0 | n/d / 106 | n/d | 11.7 |
| Nscale | Microsoft ex-Narvik | n/d | 37,600 | D | 5.5 | n/d / 491 | n/d | 13.9 |
| Nscale | Anthropic | 2026-08-25 | 44,600 | R (up to) | 6.0 | 460 / 460 | 16.2 | 16.2 |
| Lambda | Anthropic | 2026-09-01 (P) | 35,000 | P (Medium; band top) | 6.0 | 350 / n/d | 16.7 | n/d |
| Oracle | OpenAI (Stargate) | 2025-07/09 (P) | 300,000 | P (WSJ) | 5.0 | 4,500 / 3,750 | 13.3 | 16.0 |
| Cerebras | OpenAI | 2026-01-14 | 10,000 | P (>$10B) | 3.0 | 750 / n/d | 4.4 (naive LB) | n/d |

NON-COMPUTE facility leases (shell + power only, NOT comparable to compute $/MW): TeraWulf-Fluidstack 1.85; Cipher Mining-AWS 1.22; Cipher Mining-Fluidstack 1.79; Hut 8-Fluidstack 1.90; Applied Digital-CoreWeave 1.83; Galaxy-CoreWeave 1.90; Hut 8-NVIDIA 1.86; AIB Data Centers-Nebius (CLT1) n/d ($M per MW-yr, stated MW).

No $/MW computable (MW, term or value undisclosed): IREN-recent 3-yr contracts (unnamed); Lambda-Microsoft; Lambda-NVIDIA (GPU leaseback, main tranche); CoreWeave-Meta #1; CoreWeave-Meta #2; CoreWeave-OpenAI T1; CoreWeave-OpenAI T2; CoreWeave-OpenAI T3; CoreWeave-Jane Street; CoreWeave-Anthropic; Crusoe-Jane Street; Crusoe-Meta; Crusoe-Microsoft (Abilene 900 MW campus); Crusoe JV / Oracle-OpenAI (Abilene Stargate); Oracle-Meta; SpaceX (xAI)-Anthropic; Microsoft (Azure)-OpenAI; AWS-OpenAI; Microsoft (Azure)-Anthropic; Google Cloud-Anthropic; Google Cloud-Meta.

Tags: R reported, P press-reported, D derived, E estimated; '(up to)' = maximum TCV. Microsoft-Nebius: no MW stated by either company; shown only as the house $14.49M per IT MW-yr (E; $17.4B / 5 yrs / ~240 IT MW est., model Contracts!E12). Nebius Meta #2 and backstop tie no MW (n/d); backstop is contingent. Nebius MW is a Capacity estimate throughout. Share count: 358.56M debt convention at the $237.15 10/7 close (if-converted 376.65M above $324.65, all convert debt out of EV; 369.56M between $313.46 and $324.65); never mix share and debt sides. Nebius Q3'26 results ~Nov 10 (est.), not announced. Comp band $9.7-16.7M per MW-yr: low IREN-Microsoft $9.7M (R, IT MW); top Lambda-Anthropic ~$16.7M ($35B / 6-yr term / ~350 MW; press inputs, IT vs gross MW unstated; Medium confidence).